



Speaker 1 - 00:00

It. Hello. Be right back. Hi. Hi, sir.



Speaker 2 - 01:11

How you doing, buddy?



Speaker 1 - 01:12

Good. How's life? Excellent. Good.



Speaker 2 - 01:15

Excellent.



Speaker 1 - 01:16

Gonna be with me tonight. Gonna be with me tonight? Yep. Okay. It.



Speaker 2 - 02:16

On Amazon. I bought some essential oil.



Speaker 1 - 02:19

Oh, nice.



Speaker 2 - 02:19

And I mix it with water.



Speaker 1 - 02:21

I did it.



Speaker 2 - 02:22

And I've been spraying it with a. You just like pre sprays with water and it's a calming agent. And I brought it with me tonight if you'd like to have a squirt or two. It's really nice. It's just like.



Speaker 1 - 02:35

What kind is it?



Speaker 2 - 02:36

It's lavender.



Speaker 1 - 02:37

Oh, yeah, I do. I burn essential oils all the time.



Speaker 2 - 02:40

Oh, do you?



Speaker 1 - 02:41

I use eucalyptus, lavender, peppermint sometimes. Do different things all the time. I have a whole bunch of them. Yeah. Tea tree probably. Okay. But thank you very much. That's great. Yeah. Which. The girl was in there. Yeah. I see you were meditating.



Speaker 3 - 03:25

I'm in posture anyway.



Speaker 1 - 03:27

Right, yeah. Well, that's part of it. Right. Getting in position. I think Mike will be here in just seconds. Otherwise it just be up, which is fine. Do you have any. Any questions or feedback from previous or.

Speaker 3 - 03:53



Well, I do. You know, first I thought that, you know, I'm never going to do any kind of meditation. And, you know, sometimes it's only, you know, I only remember where I left some keys, you know, and sometime I can get in the zone for a little bit. But yeah, I just enjoy it. There's like, I used to. Before the COVID thing, I used to do the meditation and recovery meetings at the Zen center.



Speaker 1 - 04:23

Oh, cool.



Speaker 3 - 04:24

So they have like a Monday night meeting in San Francisco that's for people, you know in recovery from AA or NA or ACA or any of the AAs.



Speaker 1 - 04:35

That's great.



Speaker 3 - 04:36

Yeah.



Speaker 1 - 04:37

Is it a referee's recovery meeting or is it the Zen? Is it the Zen. The center themselves.



Speaker 3 - 04:42

So it's the Zen center themselves.



Speaker 1 - 04:44

Oh, okay. I actually work in av and I went there to upgrade some of their facilities and they didn't do it, but I met the Yoshi or whatever they call him, so. Yeah, that's really good.

Speaker 3 - 05:01



Yeah, it's really cool. I mean, it's a beautiful spot.



Speaker 1 - 05:04

It is. Yeah.



Speaker 3 - 05:05

Yeah.



Speaker 1 - 05:05

Beautiful building right there on Haight.



Speaker 3 - 05:07

Yeah, yeah. Patient Laguna right there.



Speaker 1 - 05:09

Yeah, yeah.



Speaker 3 - 05:10

And yeah, it's. It's a neat meeting they do. So they'll do sort of like Buddhist principles and the steps combined. So there'll be a little lecture and they transpose the order. Sometimes the steps are, you know, first and foremost followed by the Buddhist principle. And then sometimes it's the Buddhist principle.



Speaker 1 - 05:30

Oh, that's interesting. You said that's Monday nights.



Speaker 3 - 05:33

Monday nights, yeah.



Speaker 1 - 05:34

Maybe I'll try that sometime. Or if they're doing online, maybe I'll tune into it.



Speaker 3 - 05:38

I think they're doing online now, but I haven't checked it out. Yeah.



Speaker 1 - 05:42

Oh, that's great. That's a. So I am actually teaching you guys Buddhist principles, but I'm not really calling them necessarily that. Yes. So this is Theravadan. So this is more of the southern Buddhist kind of Thailand, Sri Lanka, Burma, that area. But it's the same teachings. It's just they've got a little bit different emphasis with Zen and so. But the other thing related to that though is Zen is closely related to none Dualism, which is another thing I'm really into. There's a teacher named Muji. Have you ever heard of Muji? Yes, My friend.



Speaker 3 - 06:30

My friend Lakshmi loves Muji.



Speaker 1 - 06:33

Oh, I love him too. Oh, my gosh.



Speaker 3 - 06:36

So I listen to like I just started listening to a couple on Insight Timer because.



Speaker 1 - 06:40

Oh, yeah, I have Insight Timer, so maybe you'll see me there. And we. Yeah, Muji is great. Oh my gosh. I am so. In fact, when I talk to you guys about the knower, actually it comes from some teachings I know from Jack Kornfield, but I also know them from Mooji and from other non. I have a couple of non dual teachers. I follow a guy named Rupert Spira and a few others that I can't remember their names because Rupert Spira, he comes in Berkeley twice a year. There's a group called Open. Open Secret. Oh, that is a non dual. It's a non dual organization. They have a mailing list that you can get on so that you get all of the Bay Area notices of. Of different events. Oh, cool. Yeah. Open Secret. And so I. I hooked up with Rupert's Spira.



Speaker 1 - 07:40

They have a lot of events in Berkeley.



Speaker 3 - 07:43

How's his last name spell?



Speaker 1 - 07:44

S P, I, R A Spira. Yeah, he's a. He was a potter, so he's an artist.



Speaker 3 - 07:52

Yeah.



Speaker 1 - 07:52

And his teacher is a guy named Francis Lucille. And he's another famous non Dual art person. And so, yeah, that's a. That's a great. Muji is. I love Muji and I'm. I'm getting a lot into. I think his teachings are simple. You know, I'm going to try. I try to introduce some of that here, some of those things here that I introduce and then mix it with the Buddhist stuff. And so would you like some combination it's lavender.



Speaker 3 - 08:36

Oh, I would love some lavender.



Speaker 2 - 08:40

Go ahead.



Speaker 3 - 08:42

Okay.

Speaker 1 - 08:44



There you go.



Speaker 4 - 08:45

Yeah, the combination.



Speaker 3 - 08:46

Yeah.



Speaker 2 - 08:47

Really nice.



Speaker 3 - 08:48

I love lavender essential oil. Why, thank you, Mike. It's wonderful.



Speaker 1 - 08:54

It's there. Yeah, I felt it. I saw it.



Speaker 2 - 08:57

Okay.



Speaker 3 - 08:58

That's wonderful.



Speaker 4 - 08:58

You smell it?



Speaker 3 - 08:59

Yeah. I love the smell of lavender.



Speaker 2 - 09:01

Yeah, you do?



Speaker 1 - 09:06

Yeah. Or rice.



Speaker 3 - 09:09

That's a good way to put it.



Speaker 1 - 09:10

Oh, yeah. We were just talking. She's been to the San Francisco Zen center and attended some of their meditation and recovery events. So were talking about other Zen and non dual and other practices that are related. I believe they're all related and. Yeah, that smells good. Yeah. I also practice well in recovery. I got into a group that does vision quest. So it's like Native American practice where so a vision quest in council. So what they do with vision quest is it's really a ritual for when, like, young men, well, boys become men. So they send them out into the desert, out into the. By themselves for three days with no food, and they. They're there to get a vision. That's why I call it a vision quest. And they meet their totem animal and they get a name and various things.



Speaker 1 - 10:31

And so in recovery, I'm with a group of people. In fact, my wife is one of the leaders. She's a pipe carrier. They take people out into the desert on a yearly basis to have a vision. So that's a part of the process. But the reason I thought about it is because we sage a lot and we have council, so we'll have counsel, like monthly. And so council is basically kind of like a check in kind of thing and a spiritual check in. And that's how they used to run their meetings, is they would have counsel together, the elders would talk to you about, you know, whatever spiritual teaching they had, and then they would just check in as a community, you know. So, yeah, you adapt, you adopt for spiritual practice and recovery.



Speaker 1 - 11:27

There's a lot of things that you incorporate into your life and you build that into your life, and that actually insulates you from your addictions. Right. Because we easily can get caught up in the world, right? The world. We get caught into it, into taking things really seriously. I know that I used to have this black and white thinking, that's the end of the world kind of thinking. Right. That this is doom and gloom and learning to try and get away from that kind of thinking. So having different practices. Meditation is a core one. Right. So I've set up. I had. Well, I had a little shrine



in my little Place at first, and then I moved and got a bigger room, and then I got a bigger bookshelf for the bigger shrine. Hello. How you doing? Good.



Speaker 4 - 12:35

Smells so good.



Speaker 1 - 12:37

Yeah, he's just. He sprayed us with lavender. Yeah.



Speaker 2 - 12:40

Would you like some lavender?



Speaker 1 - 12:41

No, I'm good. Sure. So you know, you set up a shrine, candles. So you sit there and meditate. You know, you set up these ceremonies for yourself that are private. You don't have to tell anybody about them, but that you have some way of setting up ceremony and ritual for yourself. Right. So it can be a protection. It could be a way of checking in. I do it in different ways. Like, for instance, when I make coffee in the morning, I meditate. Right. I'm sitting there, coffee, pots going. I'm sitting there checking in with my body. And then I try to stay there as, you know, as long as I can. And then you do the same. You know, you do these. Incorporate these practices into your. Into your life. Hello. And then that way you protect yourself. Oh, that's okay.



Speaker 1 - 14:00

We were just talking. We were just talking about ritual and different activities outside of this place. She's going to Sarasota San Francisco Zen Center. And I'm just talking about some other things.



Speaker 3 - 14:17

I'll take you to meditation and recovery.



Speaker 1 - 14:20

Yeah. They do a thing at Green Gulch every Sunday, which is a beautiful ceremony where they actually teach you some of the Zen practices. And then you sit and you listen to a Dharma talk, and you sit in meditation as a group. And then after that, they have breakfast. They have, like, a brunch, and it's outdoor, and they're like, organic. Great food. It's a beautiful place. If you can ever do that.



Speaker 3 - 14:50

I've never been there. I've just driven past it on the way up.



Speaker 1 - 14:53

Yeah. To the beach. Yeah. Mount Tam. Yeah. No, it's in Marin county by. Forget the beach. It is that.



Speaker 3 - 15:02

Yeah.



Speaker 1 - 15:03

No, Tennessee Valley is the first beach. That's the second one. So you go towards. Towards Muir Woods. Past Muir Woods. Muir Beach. Yeah, Muir Beach. So I was just talking about ways we can incorporate spiritual practice and meditation into our life. I was talking about having a shrine. I've had three shrines now because I've outgrown one, and I've got a bigger. A different one and different ones. So these things are kind of protections that you can bring into your life so that you don't get lost and caught up in the world and forget spiritual practice. Because it's really easy. You know, you're worried about paying the bills and Keeping up with your jobs and, you know, all your obligations and your social engagements, and we can easily get swept away in these things. And so having some practices that keep you grounded.



Speaker 1 - 16:02

I was talking about. I'm involved in some Native American practices with vision quests, and we do council every month, various kinds of things. So the different ways that you can incorporate spirituality into your practice. I brought in meditation into the council because people weren't meditating. But I brought it in myself. And to be honest with you, I was afraid to even be by myself in the forest alone for three days when I first did my vision quest. So being able to be on vision quest and experiencing that connection with the earth that you get when you're doing that helped inform my meditation practice in my spiritual practice. So you can incorporate this in different ways that you can be creative. It's yours. You know, nobody needs to know. You can create your own practice here.



Speaker 1 - 17:04

And you might just want to check in with different teachers and teachings and things like that to make sure that you're not venturing off in the never land, which is. Can be also very easy, too, also. So. So it's some. It can be good to have a teacher. To be honest with you, I've had, like, four teachers, and none of them have stuck. But I feel I have, like, 20 teachers, so it really doesn't matter, you know, I mean, so how do we get involved? I'm local, and I was actually talking to my therapist today. She mentioned that you had, like, a group one. I do. I have Marin Mindful Recovery. Recovery. Do you want to write that down or. I don't have anything, but maybe I'll give you.



Speaker 2 - 17:49

I do want to get involved in.

Speaker 1 - 17:50



Some of that stuff. Here. I have a card.



Speaker 2 - 17:54

You have another one?



Speaker 1 - 17:55

I have one, Yeah. I have a group that we meet on Sunday evenings on Zoom. And it is. I'll have to bring some more cards. Yeah. Okay. So I'll. That's my name and phone number and name of the group is on there. I have a website. I would love to have you. In fact, some others from here have joined in. So group is starting to grow a little bit. Yeah. And I'm here to just basically plant the seeds of spiritual practice. It's meditation, but there's a lot to meditation that has to do with other factors. So how you behave in the world is really important. So if you're lying, cheating, and stealing and you expect to be peaceful, that's delusional. Right. If you're sitting around with angry thoughts all day, Then maybe you need to check, you know, how you're.



Speaker 1 - 18:52

How you're approaching, how you're looking at the world. Because if you're having these kind of conflicts, there's one central, one person involved that's having these conflicts, and that's us, right? If I'm the one that's putting out certain energy, I have to look at what I'm. What I'm getting back. And that's one of the beautiful things about meditation, is that it's a mirror for the mind so that we. The mind is showing you what you're putting out. I like to call it. I say, I created a box, I get in the box, and inside the box is just mirrors, right? So it's all reflecting back myself. So I'm learning to be responsible for what I'm putting out, right? I have to be responsible for that. Because otherwise, if I'm. I have to. I can't expect the world to change for me.



Speaker 1 - 19:53

I have to change to meet the world. And so those are very critical things I can't forget. And it's very easy for us to get lost in our views, our opinions, our ideals, our beliefs, our biases, the way things should be, the way that we should be, our history, our memories. We get so absorbed in all these things, right? And we identify with these things as who we are. But those. We're not any of those things. Those things are conditioned, right? They're not ours to own. They're just here and they're here and then they're gone. So for us to pay attention to this and then learning to be skillful in what we put our attention, right? Being skillful with what we apply our effort.



Speaker 1 - 20:47

So if we're applying effort that's causing us stress and suffering, or stress and suffering for other people, then maybe we should check that activity, right? Check in and inform ourselves of it. All we have to do is look the way the mind normally does it is. It self justifies itself. It codes itself. Oh, Andy, you're such a good boy. You're doing so great. Everybody loves you know, and you know what I mean? That's the attitude the ego has, right? Or it's telling you're a piece of crap. Why don't you go do some drugs and alcohol? That'll make you feel better. It's lying to you, but you believe it. You identify with it. And so we want to pay attention to these kind of things, pay attention to this, pay attention to that. That's why this mirror and not just digest all the garbage, right.



Speaker 1 - 21:42

Be to be careful about what we feed on. And feeding is mentally and spiritually and physically. Right? We eat burgers every day. You're probably gonna have a short lifespan, you're gonna have heart disease and other things that happen as a result of it. Right. And so these kind of things, you probably should eat some fruit and vegetables again. You see what I'm saying? This is what we want to. We want to elicit in terms of our spiritual practice also. So it's a. It's. I like to feel, you know, we're plant. I'm planting the seed here. You're introduced to this if you don't already have a practice, but that, you know, you. That we. We remember this and we need to be remember. Reminded from frequently.



Speaker 1 - 22:30

So that's why going to some place like Green Gulch or then, you know, doing recovery meetings, going to aa. AA was great for me when my meditation practice was weak, right. I got some benefit, you know, out of it. So I was okay. I wasn't able to deal with my meditation practice too well, so AA supported me. But then my meditation practice grew and I didn't really need as much aa. I still stay, keep both feet in both doors, right? Because who knows, tomorrow I might not be a right mind. You know, we can't take our mental faculties for granted. I've had mental issues and so I'm aware of that. So I just can't take that for granted. Granted that I'm just going to be of right mind every day. Some days I might have some insane idea of putting whiskey in the milk.



Speaker 1 - 23:31

That's from aa, right? Speaking right there. And I want to be, you know, I want to. I want to check myself. Hey, this is whiskey in the milk. This is crazy, right? I need to be able to have some checks and balances on myself. So making my. Trying to make it this. These are things are. This is to me what mindfulness is about. Me and things that we to remember. Right. There are other. There's other ways you can word it, but this is what mindfulness means to me, reminding me to think in these terms over and over again. So any questions? Okay, so why don't we practice? Sure, no problem. And anybody not experienced meditating, you need any guidance? Well, okay, so. All right, well, what I'll do is I'll just give a little instruction at the very beginning then. Okay. All right.



Speaker 1 - 25:12

So bringing our awareness into our bodies before we do anything at all, let's just sit here in our body for a moment, not Very long. But just sit here and not do anything. Don't follow your breath, don't think. Be aware of this urge to do. And we can and begin meditating by keeping our awareness in the body and being aware of the things that we can sense the pressure of the floor on our feet, but on the cushion, any tension we might have in the body, the shoulders and the neck, moving your shoulders to like to release it. Checking if there's any tension in the eyes or in the forehead temples, just allowing it to let go. Then bringing a couple of conscious breaths, breathing in energy, healing energy.



Speaker 1 - 27:33

And then on the exhale, letting go and keeping our awareness in the body, just tuning into this rhythm of our breathing, being aware of the start of each in breathing in. And then there's a pause and then there's an out breath. And then at the end of the out breath there's another pause and this cycle repeating itself. Other things may come into your awareness. Feelings in pleasant feelings or unpleasant feelings or maybe thoughts. Planning, mind. For now, just put those things aside, you know, not trying to push them away. Just let them be their own accord or pass away. Coming back to the rhythm of this breathing. Periodically checking in with yourself to see if you've drifted off into a thought. And if you have, it's okay.



Speaker 1 - 31:28

Bowing to it, Coming back to this body and the breath open up to any questions anybody might have or comments or insights. Okay? So just as a reinforcement of the practice is really, we're not here to suppress anything or stop anything. This knowing quality of knowing what's going on. So you can turn thinking into a meditation object if you

need to. That's what I'm getting. Okay, so if you're having a lot of thinking, know thinking. This is what thinking's like. Just like knowing, hearing. This is what hearing is like. Knowing feeling. This is what feeling is like. You see, I'm saying you can turn that into a practice. And what happens sometimes it's interesting sometimes when you pay attention to something in a certain way, it's like, oh, you found me out. I'm gonna run and go away. I don't need.



Speaker 1 - 48:32

I don't need to be here. Sometimes you can think about something and reinforce it. So then you can look a little deeper. So what are you finding so interesting about the thinking? Right. So you could start looking into. So I was gonna talk about that. So there's different aspects of mindfulness. It's actually the word for. It's vipassana. It's also insight meditation. So we're here to gain insight into the nature of things. So you're here to observe basically this knowing, observe what's going on. And so like I was saying about the mirror of the mind that's reflecting everything, it's just showing you it's reflecting back, right. What its nature is, the mind. What does the mind do? It thinks, right? So when, so we can, you can look at other levels and aspects of thinking and gain some insight, right?



Speaker 1 - 49:38

So for instance, I have a video game that I play all the time. So whenever I get bored or when I'm bored or I don't want to think about what I'm thinking about, sometimes that game will come up in my head immediately. I can go do that and I can avoid myself, right? So I'm thinking, right? I'm thinking I'm impatient, but I'm not paying attention to the, you know, the noticing, the impatient part. I'm just jumping right to the habitual thing. So we want to be able to look at all of everything so you can turn it into an object as you need, right. So that's something you tune into. I have different things. So one of the things about this insight is it's very intuitive. So we talk about following the breath as you're anchor being in the body. But that's really.



Speaker 1 - 50:41

If not much is going on, right? So if you're not having anything going on, right. That you have to pay attention to. I was telling the other group, just, it's like you're watching sheep, so you're squashing the sheep and the sheep are your, is your. You want to make sure that they don't run off, right. They don't go and trample the vegetable gardens and. Or a wolf comes to kill them, right? So you want to watch them and make sure they're safe. But if they're safe, so then you just let, let be, right? So this is kind of like the breath. If everything's cool, everything with the breath is cool. You're focused on, you know, you're painting, paying attention to what's going on. Just go with it.



Speaker 1 - 51:31

If you know something's a little off, then maybe you pay attention to that, you know, see what that is, investigate it. And then when you're done, come back to just watching the sheep eat the grass. Right. See, is that helpful? Yeah. So no, we don't. We're not here to create more stress and suffering from ourselves, right. We're learning to be skillful, learning the skill, training ourselves so that we can see how we cause our own suffering, right? Wanting to be things, to be a certain way is a source of suffering. And so when we can allow things to be however they are, then we're not feeding that. That. That negative energy that's actually enabling them in a way. Right? And so that's really.



Speaker 1 - 52:29

And then it'll just say, oh, you know, I think I mentioned another time that sometimes on retreats I have like songs going through my head constantly. So it's like the mind is. Need something to chew on. Chew, chew, chew. You don't have to pay attention to it. So that's another thing. You don't have to pay attention to the thinking, right? You could just allow the thinking. Thinking. But you're here following the breath, thinking. Following the breath, thinking. You see what I'm saying? So you could. Or sometimes I just bring them together. Okay, I'm thinking, I'm going to breathe with the thinking. Pain. That's what pain taught me, right? I have pain. Okay, Just breathing with the pain, Right? See, I'm saying, so this is where it's creative, where you can have fun.



Speaker 1 - 53:17

And it's really good for you to be think in a creative manner instead of it getting really dry. Because falling to breath to be really dry, right? And so you can be creative with it. Make it fun and interesting for yourself. In fact, interest, be interested. Part of the practice. So we're mindful. Then the next thing is we're investigating what I was just talking about. So we're investigating what's going on. Okay, I'm following the breath. Breath doesn't feel good. Okay. What would make you feel good? You know what I'm saying? Okay, now the breath feels really good. Okay, this is. All right. You're noticing what's going on. Thoughts are coming. Okay, I'm just gonna let the thoughts go. Oh, that's a great thought. Oh, wait a minute. I shouldn't be doing that. You understand what I'm saying?



Speaker 1 - 54:05

And then you're constantly talking to yourself, right? And coaching yourself, teaching yourself what works. Doesn't work. See, it's very intuitive here. So then guess what happens then? This is the. I'm talking about seven factors here. The awakening. Then all of a sudden you're creating energy in your practice to. The momentum goes, right? And then there's actually. It creates joy and then it creates tranquility. Then you concentrate it. Because the mind is joyful and happy, it's easily concentrated, right? Then you're getting more and more absorbed into it. And then you're warm, pointed, then you're really tuned in to. And the idea is we're tuned in. This awareness gets more refined and it can start seeing every little movement of the mind, like a still pond. So it's a still pond. There's nothing. It's unblemished, it's clear, it's pure, right? You can see right through it.



Speaker 1 - 55:06

And then an insect drops into the pond, and you can see that. You can see the ripple. That's the movement of the mind, right? So that's how still we're were hoping to get. Because we can see all this stuff happening better when we're all stirred up, when there's. It's all muddled and everybody's trampling into it. And there's all the sense stuff going on, right? You can't notice anything. There's too much going on. Right? There's too much going on. So the idea for meditation also is for things to settle down, enjoy a little peace, tranquility. Then all of a sudden you can see things the way they are. Things are arising, passing away. Things are not us, right? We see things happening. We have no control. Any of this stuff is happening. It's just happening. We're watching it.



Speaker 1 - 55:57

When that happens, then we don't stick on and glue onto things and make them personal. When there's an emotion or a feeling or a thought, we don't have to hold on to it, right? We can just let it be of its own accord. And we see, then we learn, oh, well, what's here? What's watching all this? What's watching all this is this knower again. This knower in quality gets stronger. This knowing quality gets stronger. And then that's. And it doesn't change. It doesn't get emotional. It doesn't get sick. It's here, it's ever present. Then we notice. Oh, okay. So that's. This is where we get into the whole deeper level of understanding that we want to get into. You see what I'm saying? So I'm trying to give you the whole path so you get a feeling for what's going on.



Speaker 1 - 56:55

So you're here to learn a skill, right? This is a skill, and that's why you. We practice it. And if you're in this mode, your disease is nowhere in the picture because, you know, the hindrances. If you're in. If you're in, you know, anxiety and anger and just compulsiveness or doubting or restlessness and worry, right? If you're in that mode, then that's when everything is unskillful and you're out of control, Right. And you have no ability to deal with anything. So this is also learning the skill is learning how do we deal with those kinds of things. And really we just kind of like become disinterested in them because they cause stress and suffering. So why should we be putting energy into it? We want to be having happy, joyous and free. Right.



Speaker 1 - 57:54

So our wisdom is going to say, okay, I'm gonna not engage in this kind of thinking or mode of being. And I'm, you know, you start making wise choices, right? And it gets more and more refined. The road actually gets narrower. You become more sensitive. So right now you think you're sensitive or you're still sensitive, but what happens is you start letting go of things you don't need to be worrying about, but you're still sensitive to everything else. Right? It becomes more and more refined until, yeah, until the very end. So that's kind of the path. Andy's description of it. Any questions about any of that? Kind of give you an overview of what we're doing here. So you guys are here practicing a skill that if you know, if you practice it, you apply it.



Speaker 1 - 58:55

If you have any questions, you know, then you seek somebody that has some knowledge, you know, that you know, can maybe give you some guidance. You're following the teachings. There's lots of great teachings out there. I was talking to her about Mooji today. It was a non dual kind of thing. That's this whole idea of the knower, you know, the one that knows great teacher. I would highly recommend you listen to him. And so there's so many good. There's so much good teaching, so much teachings on meditation and mindfulness out there these days. It's all beneficial. And other practices, that's what I was talking about when we first started. There's other practices you can incorporate in. Sometimes I like to have these things scheduled. So I've got one or two things a month that are just happening other than AA meetings and other things.



Speaker 1 - 59:53

So that if something happens, probably there's a meeting or something I can do that's going to reconnect me with my practice so I don't stray too far. And then you start building a life around yourself that's based on sobriety, based on sober kinds of things. And you know, meditation practice is very sobering. Right. You know, kind of thing. Right. You start associating with, you know, your choices are, you know, different hey, Andy.



Speaker 2 - 01:00:29

I just had a question. If you ever meditated to the point where you stop breathing.



Speaker 1 - 01:00:38

Yeah, I have.



Speaker 2 - 01:00:40

And your body just says, hey, you stop breathing.



Speaker 1 - 01:00:45

No, actually, it's even more. It's more beautiful than that.



Speaker 2 - 01:00:49

Well and good.



Speaker 1 - 01:00:50

Yeah.



Speaker 2 - 01:00:52

Yeah, that. I've been doing that lately with my meditation. I. My exhale on my breath had been like, chopped up, like, you know what I mean?



Speaker 1 - 01:01:05

It hadn't been smooth. Okay.



Speaker 2 - 01:01:08

So this whole time I was just concentrating on that and being aware of that. And it was coming down from right here.



Speaker 1 - 01:01:19

Okay.



Speaker 2 - 01:01:20

Physically.



Speaker 1 - 01:01:21

Okay.



Speaker 2 - 01:01:22

It was like that half inch to an inch below my chest plate.





Speaker 1 - 01:01:25

Okay. Your diaphragm then. Yeah. Okay.



Speaker 2 - 01:01:28

And I kind of like pushed on it and it made my breathing smooth.



Speaker 1 - 01:01:34

Okay.



Speaker 2 - 01:01:35

It was.



Speaker 1 - 01:01:35

It was really nice. Okay.



Speaker 2 - 01:01:38

Actually.



Speaker 1 - 01:01:39

Okay, that's cool.



Speaker 2 - 01:01:40

And it did. I just like went to the place and I kind of pressed on it and it made my exhale, like, so smooth. Wow.



Speaker 1 - 01:01:50

Yeah, I have that. I have that where like I'm in a sweatshirt right now. I have different kinds of sweatshirts, some of them pockets are a little higher, some over a little lower. And I was on a retreat, concentration retreat. And I noticed I

had different. So I'd have my hands out sometimes, and I have them in sometimes. I noticed my breathing was different, my blood pressure. Because you. When you really get into meditation, you can hear your heart beating. You can hear your blood pulsing through the nada sound. I don't know if you know about the nada sound. It's a kind of like a high pitch sound. It's like white noise. People think they have tinnitus. Yeah. You can use that as an object of meditation. That's a really good thing to focus on if you want. Yes, you can.



Speaker 1 - 01:02:43

You can use it as an object of meditation. Yes. Yeah. So there's different things that you'll learn. Right. That you'll get attuned to. But I notice that if I move my hands a little bit, then all of a sudden my. My blood pressure would go up. I would feel a little anxious and I'd put down and I'd relax and everything changes. So you notice all these environmental things, these little things that you're doing. How you breathe affects the way you feel. Right. The way. So noticing the way your body is. The breath is a conditioner for the body. When you notice the state of your breathing, you're actually kind of noticing the state of the mind and the body and together. Right. Because they're. They affect each other.



Speaker 2 - 01:03:32

It was pretty intense because like you were talking about the heart and it pumping really strong and you know what I mean? That kind of really intense for me to. We're like on the verge of.



Speaker 1 - 01:03:46

A panic attack, right?



Speaker 2 - 01:03:48

But then a change and then I press this for some reason and it just calmed down again.



Speaker 1 - 01:03:56

Okay. Sometimes, sometimes it is helpful for us. If you're feeling a little emotional or a little bit out of control, putting your hand on your heart would be a good thing. You know, like a connection thing is a good thing, a nurturing thing. So that may have also helped you with that. So, yeah, those are, that's a good thing for you to do. Sometimes people can't feel their breath, right? It gets so refined. So if you have a, or maybe there. You're not used to following your breath. You know, it may not even be a meditator, but you're having a hard time finding your breathing. Just put your hand on your lung, on your diaphragm, and you could feel right through your fingers, you know, so there's different ways that you can find it.



Speaker 1 - 01:04:41

And then also if that happens, you can also take a couple of conscious breaths, right. So that you could find it. Right. And get. So there's different ways, but just on. The last thing I want to talk about the breathing is I've had it where my breathing did stop. And you may not know this, but you actually breathe through your pores of your skin too. So. And so the breathing, I was fine. I, I couldn't let go of my breathing, couldn't feel my breathing at all, and everything was fine. You relax and you learn to relax into that. There's, there's a little bit of breathing going on, but it's so refined. You can't tell. But you don't need a lot of breathing because you're so. You're not putting a lot of energy.



Speaker 1 - 01:05:30

Our thinking is where we spend most of our, put our, most of our energy, right. Other than moves physically moving the body, all the rest of that energy is going in the brain, right? So if you relax the brain, you're not using burning up energy, right? So that means you need less oxygen to do that, right? So. All right, so if you need it, your body's going go, you know, it's going to breathe. Yeah. You better start breathing, right? Yeah. And that's another thing you could do if you're having a difficult time with your breath, purposely stop breathing. Don't hold your breath, just purposely stop breathing. And allow the automatic breathing thing to just start on its own. You see what I'm saying? You can know it's like a reboot because sometimes we get so in our.



Speaker 4 - 01:06:27

Actually, when did those things happen? It was different. This is a very different experience. So when you're saying about the hands. So anyway, like, my mind was going. I was just starting out like this. My mind was all over the map. And then I went. And then, like, the hand kind of stopped bringing in. But it's. It wasn't like a teacher, so it felt really good.



Speaker 1 - 01:06:50

Good. Yeah.



Speaker 4 - 01:06:51

And I just went with that and just breathed out. And then I was, like, feeling this energy field.



Speaker 1 - 01:06:57

That's kind of different for me. And.



Speaker 4 - 01:06:59

And again, the hands. Like, I was doing different things. Just felt like that. It almost like it felt like this circle.



Speaker 1 - 01:07:06

Yeah.



Speaker 4 - 01:07:06

Yeah.



Speaker 1 - 01:07:07

So that's great.



Speaker 4 - 01:07:08

I was in a zone. It wasn't without thoughts and it wasn't without the.



Speaker 1 - 01:07:14

That's okay.



Speaker 4 - 01:07:15

Also, this just kind of cool sense of energy.



Speaker 1 - 01:07:20

Great. Okay. Well, we're over time, so I need to.



Speaker 2 - 01:07:31

Sign paper.



Speaker 1 - 01:07:32

Sign papers. Okay. Remind me next time I'm here. Okay.



Speaker 4 - 01:07:39

Okay.



Speaker 1 - 01:07:47

You got a lot on here. I do? You do. I like it. I'll see you guys on New Year's Day next. Yeah. You're welcome. You're welcome. Thank you for your input. You guys have a good night. Ma'am. All right. Andy. Yeah. Yeah. Will you be well? Wow. Yeah. I took a picture.